

# THE BLACKWATER SYNDICATE & BLACKWATER SECURITY INTERNATIONAL

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"Still water runs deep. Black water runs deepest."

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## Writers' Note — Two Faces of One Empire

|                         | The Blackwater Syndicate                                                                                                                                        | Blackwater Security International (BSI)                                                                                     |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>What</b>             | A criminal organization                                                                                                                                         | A multinational private security and risk-management corporation                                                            |
| <b>Founded</b>          | <b>Friday, September 29, 2000</b> (secretly)                                                                                                                    | <b>Tuesday, April 16, 2002</b> (publicly)                                                                                   |
| <b>Founder</b>          | "Sovereign" (secretly <b>Marc-Anthony Bullock</b> , then 18)                                                                                                    | <b>Marc-Anthony Bullock</b> , Founder, Chairman & CEO (then 20)                                                             |
| <b>Status</b>           | The largest, most successful, powerful, influential, respected, beloved, feared, dangerous, deadly, charitable, and valuable criminal organization in the world | One of the largest, most successful, powerful, influential, respected, beloved, feared, and valuable companies in the world |
| <b>Public knowledge</b> | Known to exist. Its leader's identity is <b>unknown</b> .                                                                                                       | Everyone knows it, and it's on every magazine cover.                                                                        |
| <b>The link</b>         | <b>Secret</b> . BSI is both a real, legitimate giant and the Syndicate's perfect shield.                                                                        |                                                                                                                             |

**Continuity convention:** In the *Beyond the Kingdom* universe, there is no real-world company called "Blackwater USA." The name "Blackwater" belongs only to Marc-Anthony's empire.

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## PART ONE — THE BLACKWATER SYNDICATE

### The Origin: The Night of July 15, 2000

- **Saturday, July 15, 2000, about 11:50 PM.** **Grace Bullock, 16**, sneaks out to a "summer white party" at a rented mansion off Habersham Road in Buckhead. It's thrown by a nightclub promoter named **Vaughn "Silk" Harlow**.
- Harlow's crew runs a **trafficking ring** that targets young women at parties. Grace is drugged.
- **Marc-Anthony (18) and Amond (18)** have followed her there because Marc had "a feeling." At **12:40 AM** they find her half-conscious, being carried toward a black Suburban by two men.
  - What happens next takes **four minutes**. Both men are hospitalized. Amond drives Grace to Piedmont Hospital. Marc stays behind.

- **The betrayal of the system:**
  - Harlow is protected by **APD Sergeant Dale Pruitt**, who is on his payroll, and by a **Fulton County commissioner** who is his silent partner.
  - The toxicology report is "lost." The case is **closed by August 22, 2000**.
  - Even Robert Bullock's connections can't reopen it. Robert tells his son: **"Sometimes the system just loses, son."**
  - Marc answers: **"Then I'll build a new one."**

## The Founding: The River Gate, September 29, 2000

- **Friday, September 29, 2000, 11:59 PM**, at the **River Gate boathouse** on the Chattahoochee below Belmont Crest.
- Present: **Marc-Anthony Bullock (18), Amond Baker (18), and Rashad "Saint" Mayfield (19)**, son of the Bullocks' longtime driver, who grew up on the estate alongside Marc.
- **The name:**
  - When Marc was a boy, Great-Grandfather Alexander brought him to this same dock and told him: *"At night the river looks black. People are scared of it. But it's the same water that carried our people north, that baptized them, and that hid them. Still water runs deep, boy. Black water runs deepest."*
  - Marc took the name from the river.
- **The first act:** Marc sets a polished **black onyx coin** on the dock, engraved with a **crown above a wave**. It becomes the Syndicate's mark: **the Onyx Coin**.
- **The first oath:** *"Nobody touches the innocent. Nobody touches the family. And nobody ever sees my face."*

## The First War: Dismantling the Harlow Ring (October–December 2000)

- Over 11 weeks, the Harlow ring falls apart:
  - **Fourteen young women** are found and brought home, with their families' bills paid anonymously.
  - Sergeant Pruitt resigns in disgrace in November 2000 after anonymous evidence reaches Internal Affairs and the newspapers.
  - The commissioner is indicted in December 2000.
  - **Vaughn "Silk" Harlow and three of his lieutenants are never seen again.** Each of their empty apartments has an Onyx Coin on the kitchen table.
  - **SECRET (Blackwater's only failure):** Harlow **survived** "the river" with his face destroyed. In April 2001 he paid Dr. Peter Olson \$5 million to rebuild it in Cancún. In **2005** he returns to Atlanta as **"Julian Cross"** (see Document 07). Nobody in the Syndicate knows.

- The streets start whispering a name: "**Sovereign.**"

## Growth (2001–2004)

| Date                                      | Event                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Early 2001</b>                         | Recruitment of the core. The Syndicate takes over the ring's former territory and its illegal gambling operations and "cleans" them: no predators, no minors, no drugs sold to kids.                                                                                                         |
| <b>Spring 2001</b>                        | <b>Tobias Okafor</b> , a 21-year-old MIT dropout, joins as "The Ledger." <b>Keisha Lattimore</b> ("Ghost"), a hacker, is recruited after she breaks into Harvard's systems to change Marc's parking tickets as a job application.                                                            |
| <b>Summer 2001</b>                        | <b>Roman Gaines</b> , a decorated Army Ranger discharged for striking an officer who used a slur, joins as "The Hammer." <b>Dolores "Mama Dee" Whitfield</b> joins as "The Tithe" after Sovereign finds her grandson's killer.                                                               |
| <b>Tuesday, January 1, 2002, ~2:40 AM</b> | Marc covers up Arianna Cummings' fatal accident (see Document 02). Blackwater and Silas Merriweather are still at peace, so the body goes to a Merriweather crematorium as a favor. <b>SECRET</b> : Silas keeps Darnell Divine's wallet as insurance.                                        |
| <b>Tuesday, April 16, 2002</b>            | <b>BSI is founded.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>2002–2003</b>                          | Expansion across the Southeast, then nationally: Atlanta, Miami, Houston, New Orleans, Charlotte, D.C., New York, Chicago, Los Angeles.                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Friday, March 14, 2003</b>             | <b>The Nassau Accord.</b> On Alexander's birthday, Sovereign meets through intermediaries with criminal organizations from the Caribbean, London, Lagos, Rotterdam, and Marseille in a Nassau villa. They all agree to Blackwater's terms, rules, and cut. <b>The Syndicate goes global.</b> |
| <b>Summer 2004</b>                        | <b>"The Summer of Silence."</b> A war with Silas <b>"The Undertaker" Merriweather</b> , Atlanta's old-school kingpin (Document 07), over Southside territory. Eleven Merriweather properties burn. Nobody talks.                                                                             |
| <b>Saturday, August 14, 2004</b>          | <b>The Sweet Auburn Truce.</b> Amond and Silas meet at a table in the back of Mama Dee's restaurant. Silas keeps his funeral homes and his pride. Blackwater keeps everything else.                                                                                                          |
| <b>Monday, November 15, 2004</b>          | The FBI Atlanta Field Office opens <b>"Operation Deep Water,"</b> led by <b>Special Agent Kathleen Doyle</b> (Document 07).                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Monday, December 20, 2004</b>          | At her swearing-in, <b>Chief Elxa Jackson</b> announces the <b>APD Blackwater Task Force</b> and promises: <i>"Whoever Sovereign is, I will find him, and I will put him in a cell."</i> Her brother is in the second row. He applauds louder than anyone.                                   |

## Structure of the Syndicate (2005)

### SOVEREIGN

- **Marc-Anthony Bullock.** Absolute authority. Known in person only to The Seven (and to Arianna Cummings, who is not a member).

- To everyone else, Sovereign is a voice on a secure line, a handwritten note in green ink, or an Onyx Coin.

### THE SEVEN ("The Table")

| Seat | Title                                        | Member                       | Age (1/3/05) | Public Cover                                            |
|------|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | <b>Sovereign</b>                             | Marc-Anthony Bullock         | 22           | Chairman & CEO, BSI                                     |
| 2    | <b>The Right Hand</b> (Underboss)            | Amond Baker                  | 22           | SVP of Strategic Operations, BSI                        |
| 3    | <b>The Ledger</b> (Finance)                  | Tobias Okafor                | 24           | Chief Financial Officer, BSI                            |
| 4    | <b>The Ghost</b> (Intelligence & Archive)    | Keisha Lattimore             | 25           | Director of Cyber & Information Assurance, BSI          |
| 5    | <b>The Hammer</b> (Enforcement & Operations) | Roman Gaines                 | 28           | Director of Global Operations, BSI                      |
| 6    | <b>The Tithe</b> (Charity & Community)       | Dolores "Mama Dee" Whitfield | 53           | Owner, Dee's Kitchen (West End)                         |
| 7    | <b>The Saint</b> (Streets & Territory)       | Rashad "Saint" Mayfield      | 23           | BSI Community Liaison / owner of Saint's Car Wash chain |

### THE EIGHTH CHAIR

- An **eighth chair** stands at the Table, and **it's always empty**.
- When asked, Sovereign says only: **"It's for someone I haven't met yet."**
- (*Writers' foreshadowing: the Queen's Chair.*)

### THE HOUSES (Operational Divisions)

| House              | Run By         | Activity (kept deliberately general on screen)                                                                     |
|--------------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The Parlors</b> | Saint & Ledger | Invitation-only, high-stakes underground gambling in 30 cities. <b>Gideon Ashe owes the Parlors \$212 million.</b> |
| <b>The Harbor</b>  | Hammer         | Smuggling of contraband cargo and untaxed luxury goods through ports worldwide                                     |
| <b>The Archive</b> | Ghost          | Intelligence brokering. The Syndicate holds files on corrupt politicians, judges, CEOs, and police, and uses them. |
| <b>The Ledger</b>  | Ledger         | Moves and cleans money for the Syndicate and its allies through shell companies worldwide                          |
| <b>The Shield</b>  | Right Hand     | "Protection" of businesses the Syndicate controls, and political fixing                                            |
| <b>The Hunt</b>    | Hammer & Ghost | Tracking and destroying predators, traffickers, and anyone who breaks the Code                                     |
| <b>The Tithe</b>   | Mama Dee       | The Syndicate's charitable arm                                                                                     |

### Scale (2005)

- **Members:** An estimated 40,000 worldwide across all affiliates. Only about 300 have ever spoken directly with one of The Seven.
  - **Revenue:** The FBI estimates more than \$60 billion a year. **The true figure is more than triple that.**
  - **Reach:** Present in 58 countries through the Nassau Accord.
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## THE BLACKWATER CODE (The Ten Laws)

1. **Nobody touches a child. Ever.**
2. **No trafficking in human beings.** We hunt those who do.
3. **No poison on our own streets.** We don't sell hard drugs in our communities.
4. **Women, elders, and the innocent are off-limits.**
5. **Loyalty is paid in full. Betrayal is paid in full.**
6. **Nobody sees Sovereign's face** except The Seven.
7. **The Tithe:** A share of every dollar goes back to the people.
8. **Don't bring heat home.**
9. **Clean cops are left alone. Dirty cops belong to us.**
10. **Family is sacred.** Every member's family is under Blackwater protection, for life.

**Breaking Laws 1 or 2 is the only unforgivable sin.** The penalty is spoken of only as "the river."

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## THE TITHE — "Spare No Expense"

The Syndicate is the most charitable criminal organization in history. The Tithe:

- **Pays off medical debt** for entire hospital wards, anonymously. The receipts arrive with an Onyx Coin.
- **"Blackwater Christmas":** Every December 24 since 2000, toys, turkeys, and \$500 envelopes appear on the doorsteps of 20,000+ families in Atlanta's poorest neighborhoods.
- **The Envelope Scholarships:** Full tuition, delivered in cash-funded trusts, to kids nobody else invests in.
- Funds **women's shelters**, funeral costs, and back rent. After the Summer of Silence, it rebuilt every Southside house that burned by accident.
- **The result:** In parts of Atlanta, **Sovereign is a folk hero.** Kids spray-paint the crown and wave on walls. Grandmothers pray for him by name. *"Who is Sovereign?"* is the city's favorite question.

### The Onyx Coin

- A black onyx coin with a **crown over a wave**.
- **Left at a scene:** Blackwater did this.
- **Given to a person:** That person is **under Blackwater protection**. Anyone who touches them answers to Sovereign.
- **Mama Dee carries the first 1,000 ever made.**

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## PART TWO — BLACKWATER SECURITY INTERNATIONAL (BSI)

### At a Glance (January 2005)

| Item                    | Detail                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Legal name              | Blackwater Security International, Inc. (BSI)                                                                                       |
| Type                    | Privately held multinational private security and risk-management corporation                                                       |
| Founded                 | <b>Tuesday, April 16, 2002</b> , Atlanta                                                                                            |
| Founder, Chairman & CEO | <b>Marc-Anthony Bullock</b>                                                                                                         |
| President & COO         | <b>Lt. Gen. Walter Bassett, U.S. Army (Ret.)</b>                                                                                    |
| Headquarters            | <b>BSI Tower, 1 Blackwater Plaza, Midtown, Atlanta, GA 30309.</b> 58 stories of black glass. Marc's penthouse is on the 58th floor. |
| Training campus         | <b>The Sumter Center.</b> 9,000 acres in Sumter County, Georgia, near Alexander Donohue's birthplace.                               |
| Employees               | About 118,000 in 64 countries                                                                                                       |
| 2004 revenue            | \$31 billion                                                                                                                        |
| Valuation               | About <b>\$210 billion</b> , one of the most valuable private companies on Earth, built in under three years                        |
| Tagline                 | <b><i>"Nothing touches what we protect."</i></b>                                                                                    |

### The Founding Story (Official Version)

- After September 11, 2001, 19-year-old Harvard J.D./M.B.A. graduate Marc-Anthony Bullock saw that **the world had become unsafe, and the security industry hadn't caught up**.
- He founded BSI on **April 16, 2002** with **\$3 billion from his personal trust** and a first contract from Donohue Global Holdings.
- **Within 12 months** BSI had won port-security contracts in 11 countries, protection for 200 Fortune 500 executives, and the security contract for Belmont Crest. *Fortune* called it "the fastest-growing company in history."

## BSI Divisions

| Division                                     | Services                                                                       |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>BSI Executive Protection</b>              | Bodyguards for heads of state, CEOs, celebrities, and athletes                 |
| <b>BSI Risk &amp; Intelligence</b>           | Corporate intelligence, due diligence, political-risk analysis, investigations |
| <b>BSI Maritime &amp; Ports</b>              | Port and shipping security, anti-piracy                                        |
| <b>BSI Aviation</b>                          | Airport and private aviation security, armored aviation                        |
| <b>BSI Cyber &amp; Information Assurance</b> | Network security, data protection (advanced for 2005)                          |
| <b>BSI Armored Logistics</b>                 | Armored transport of cash, art, jewels, and sensitive cargo                    |
| <b>BSI Crisis Response</b>                   | Kidnap-and-ransom response, evacuations, disaster rescue                       |
| <b>BSI Communities</b>                       | Security for gated communities, campuses, stadiums, and events                 |
| <b>The Sumter Center</b>                     | Training academy for BSI, police departments, and allied governments           |

## Why BSI Is Respected, Beloved, and Feared

- **Respected:** Flawless record. No protected client has ever been harmed.
- **Beloved:** BSI Crisis Response teams show up **free** at disasters: floods, fires, tornadoes. Every BSI job pays at least 40% above industry rates, with full college tuition for employees' kids. BSI hires veterans and people with records who have served their time: *"Everybody deserves a second shot. Nobody gets a third."*
- **Feared:** Competitors lose contracts overnight. Journalists who dig too deep find their sources gone quiet. And everyone notices that **crime drops wherever BSI shows up**.

## BSI Leadership

| Title                                   | Name                           | Knows About the Syndicate?                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Founder, Chairman & CEO                 | Marc-Anthony Bullock           | He IS Sovereign                                                             |
| President & COO                         | Lt. Gen. (Ret.) Walter Bassett | <b>No.</b> An honorable soldier. His discovery would be a major future arc. |
| CFO                                     | Tobias Okafor                  | Yes (The Ledger)                                                            |
| SVP, Strategic Operations               | Amond Baker                    | Yes (The Right Hand)                                                        |
| Director, Global Operations             | Roman Gaines                   | Yes (The Hammer)                                                            |
| Director, Cyber & Information Assurance | Keisha Lattimore               | Yes (The Ghost)                                                             |
| Executive Assistant to the CEO          | Brielle Sutton                 | <b>No, but she suspects.</b> Fiercely loyal.                                |

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## Who's Hunting Sovereign (2005)

| Hunter                                                                      | Motive                                          | Knows It's Marc?                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Chief Elxa Jackson</b> , APD Blackwater Task Force                       | Justice. The book. Her reputation.              | <b>No</b>                                                     |
| <b>Det. Jeremy Jackson</b> , APD Homicide                                   | The Harlow disappearances (a cold case)         | No, but he's the first to notice patterns around the Bullocks |
| <b>SA Kathleen Doyle &amp; SA Daniel Reyes</b> , FBI "Operation Deep Water" | A career-making federal case                    | No                                                            |
| <b>Martin Olson</b>                                                         | Destroy Sovereign, then use the Disgrace Clause | <b>No, and when he finds out, it's war</b>                    |
| <b>Silas Merriweather</b>                                                   | Revenge for the Summer of Silence               | No                                                            |
| <b>Desmond Smilley</b>                                                      | Leverage                                        | No                                                            |

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## Future Arc Seeds (Writers Only)

1. **Hurricane Katrina (Monday, August 29, 2005)** is Elxa's 25th birthday. BSI Crisis Response and the Syndicate's Tithe mobilize massively in New Orleans, Simone's hometown. BSI rescues thousands, and Sovereign becomes a national legend.
2. **The Eighth Chair** is waiting for Esther.
3. **Gideon's marker** gives Blackwater a hidden hand inside the Smilley family.
4. **Grace's night** is the Syndicate's origin, and the reason she'd hide a body for her brother.
5. **Harmony's missing brother** is a Blackwater secret that could destroy Marc, Amond, and Arianna at once.